



RVSR JOB AID

Minimizing Sources of Error

Before determining a rating, be aware of some of the regulations, procedures, common sources of errors, and nuances when matching the disability to the Rating Schedule.

Table 1: Sources of Error

Error	Solution	Additional Information
Selected and cited incorrect code number	Select and cite the correct code number	Use great in the selection of the applicable code number and in its citation on the rating decision. No other numbers than these listed or hereafter furnished are to be used for rating purposes, with the exception of rating by analogy or in hyphenated ratings (which are explained later).
Did not assign codes to nonservice-connected disabilities	Assign codes to all disabilities	When rating a claim, remember to assign codes to all disabilities service-connected or nonservice-connected.
Rated incorrect medical term or diagnosis	Consider alternative diagnosis names	Medical terms and diagnoses are sometimes confusing and hard to understand. To assist you in indentifying these terms during rating, consider alternative names for some of the diagnoses.
Did not use all available resources	Use available references	You may also reference the Rating Job Aids, CPKM, the Internet, C&P Intranet, and medical dictionaries are good sources for research in identifying a medical term or diagnosis.



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Error	Solution	Additional Information
Mistook similar sounding medical terminology	Read medical terms carefully	Be cautious about mistaking similar sounding medical terminology when matching the claimed issue/disability to the Rating Schedule. For example, hyperthyroidism (7900) sounds very similar to hypothyroidism (7903), hyperparathyroidism (7904), and hypoparathyroidism (7905).
Used wrong plate, table, or chart	Use the proper plate, table, or chart	Be cautious when using the various plates, tables, and charts in the Rating Schedule. The proper one must be chosen, and it must be interpreted in the correct manner. Percentage numbers, degrees of vision, and other values are sometimes difficult to understand.
Assigned wrong effective date	Determine the correct effective date	Make sure you review all the information in the claims file before determining the effective date. Take into consideration whether the claim was filed within 1 year of separation from service or not. Review the date stamp on all documents and check the back and front of documentation for the earliest date recorded. Be particularly careful when selecting date entitlement arose dates from disabilities with presumptive service connection 38 CFR 3.309(a).
Did not address inferred issues	Address all the claimed and inferred issues	Make sure you address all the claimed and inferred issues before preparing the rating decision.



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Error	Solution	Additional Information
Did not request all medical records or evidence for the Veteran	Obtain all the medical evidence the Veteran identified, including VA medical information	Ensure all medical evidence is included in the file. Check both the Veteran's application and the Compensation Exam for reports of treatment elsewhere and request any medical records or information.